

T U N E A B L E

THE MUSIC COMMONS

White Paper v0.1

Discover. Support. Participate.

A community-led, artist-first infrastructure for discovering, supporting and participating in music.

September 2026

A founding statement of purpose and direction

Contents

1. Executive Summary
2. The Problem
3. The Tuneable Proposition
4. Music as a Commons
5. Artist-First Economics
6. The Low-Commission Commitment
7. Where the Money Goes
8. Democratic Music Discovery
9. Open Technology & Data
10. Participation, Parties & Communities
11. TuneBytes
12. Rights, Privacy & Integrity
13. Commercial Partnerships
14. Governance
15. Progressive Decentralisation
16. Community Ownership & Treasury
17. The Anti-Billionaire Principle
18. Measuring Success
19. The Roadmap
20. Constitutional Commitments
21. The Tuneable Covenant
22. Conclusion — The Music Commons

Founding white paper. Future commitments and proposed limits remain subject to legal, operational and constitutional review.

1. Executive Summary

Tuneable is an attempt to build a different kind of music platform.

The internet has made almost every kind of music accessible, but access is not the same as discovery, and discovery is not the same as support.

Tuneable creates a social and economic layer around music: people discover music, participate in shared listening experiences, and voluntarily place financial value behind the music they love.

Those signals can then help shape dynamic charts and discovery systems.

The underlying proposition is simple:

If people voluntarily put value behind the music they love, more of that value should find its way back into the musical ecosystem.

Tuneable is established as a UK Community Interest Company and is being built around an artist-first, community-led philosophy.

The platform is intended to become: - a mechanism for discovering music; - a way for listeners to directly support creators; - a democratic layer for music charts and communities; - open infrastructure for developers and music organisations; - and, ultimately, community-owned musical infrastructure.

Tuneable does not claim to have achieved all of this yet.

This white paper describes both **the system we are building today and the constraints we intend to place upon what Tuneable can become.**

2. The Problem

Music has never been more abundant.

Millions of artists are creating extraordinary work across every country, culture and musical tradition. Yet the systems through which people discover music remain heavily shaped by existing popularity, commercial incentives, advertising, editorial decisions and algorithmic optimisation.

This creates a familiar cycle:

Music that is already visible becomes more visible.

Meanwhile, enormous amounts of exceptional music remain difficult to discover.

Streaming platforms are extremely good at delivering music at scale. They are not necessarily designed to answer another question:

What music is a community genuinely willing to stand behind?

A play can represent passive consumption.

A tip represents active appreciation.

Tuneable is interested in making that appreciation visible.

3. The Tuneable Proposition

Tuneable brings together three things:

Discovery

A system for discovering music through community activity, support, location, tags and other signals.

Support

A mechanism through which listeners can voluntarily put financial value behind music they appreciate.

Participation

A social environment in which people can collectively influence musical experiences, including parties, playlists and charts.

Tuneable is therefore not intended to replace Spotify, YouTube, Bandcamp, Beatport, radio, record labels or DJs. It is complementary infrastructure.

The ambition is to create another layer around the existing music ecosystem:

Listen → discover → support → participate → discover more.

4. Music as a Commons

Music is not simply a product moving between an artist and a consumer.

It is an ecosystem.

A recording may involve performers, producers, songwriters, composers, engineers, labels, collectives, DJs, venues, promoters and audiences.

Tuneable's underlying architecture reflects this by recognising multiple creator roles, collectives and labels rather than reducing every piece of music to a single artist field.

The wider ambition is to treat music as a **commons**: something whose discovery, knowledge, participation and cultural value can be developed collectively.

Tuneable is established as a UK Community Interest Company because the project is intended to create community benefit rather than exist solely to maximise private shareholder return.

That principle should increasingly influence the architecture of the organisation itself.

5. Artist-First Economics

Tuneable exists to move value **toward** the musical ecosystem, not simply extract value **from** it.

The current model allocates the majority of tip revenue to artists and creators, with the platform retaining a proportion to fund its operation.

Tuneable's long-term direction is to increase the proportion reaching creators as the platform becomes more efficient and develops additional sources of sustainable revenue beyond creator-directed payments.

Creator allocations should be attributable to the relevant music and rights-holders wherever reasonably possible.

Tuneable's architecture already includes creator escrow and transaction histories, allowing value associated with music to remain connected to its intended recipients.

The principle is straightforward:

Creators should not have to surrender ownership of their work in order to participate.

Tuneable should seek to make participation inexpensive enough that even very small contributions can matter.

6. The Low-Commission Commitment

Tuneable should become one of the lowest-cost mechanisms available for directly supporting music.

We therefore propose a long-term constitutional ceiling of:

10% maximum platform commission

on creator-directed payments, subject to legal, payment-processing and operational considerations.

This figure is a proposed commitment, not a claim about the current platform economics.

Third-party payment processing, taxes, refunds, chargebacks and unavoidable external costs should be distinguished from Tuneable's own commission wherever practical.

The intention is to prevent a community-support mechanism from gradually becoming a high-margin extraction business.

As Tuneable grows, our objective should be:

More value to creators, lower cost to participate.

7. Where the Money Goes

Trust requires visibility.

Tuneable should progressively publish clear information about the flow of money through the platform, including: - total money received; - payment-processing costs; - refunds and chargebacks; - creator allocations; - creator payouts; - operating revenue; - employee and director compensation; - major operating costs; - community expenditure; - reserves; - retained surplus.

Tuneable already has a central financial ledger designed to provide a structured record of transactions, including tips, refunds, wallet activity and payouts, with transaction sequencing, balance snapshots and cryptographic integrity mechanisms.

The long-term objective is to make appropriate elements of this accounting system publicly verifiable.

This does **not** mean publishing people's private financial information.

Our principle is:

Transparent economics. Private individuals.

8. Democratic Music Discovery

Tuneable's charts are intended to represent something different from conventional popularity rankings.

They can incorporate signals such as: - financial support; - number of supporters; - discovery; - time; - location; - tags; - party activity; - community participation.

The precise mechanisms will evolve.

But the principle should remain stable:

The community should be able to understand the forces shaping its charts.

Tuneable should not secretly sell chart position.

Commercial relationships should not be disguised as organic community support.

If paid promotion or sponsorship is introduced, it should be clearly identified.

A commercial partner should not be able to quietly purchase #1 while presenting that position as a democratic community outcome.

9. Open Technology & Data

Tuneable believes important community infrastructure benefits from openness.

The long-term objective is therefore to progressively open-source significant parts of the platform.

This may include: - ranking systems; - APIs; - data structures; - governance tooling; - financial transparency tools; - selected frontend and backend infrastructure.

Security-sensitive systems, private information and legally restricted material may necessarily remain closed.

But where technology can safely be inspected, improved, reproduced or built upon by the community, Tuneable should seriously consider making it open.

The same principle applies to data.

Music should not become permanently trapped inside one company's database.

Tuneable should favour open standards, interoperable identifiers and cooperation with existing open music-data initiatives wherever practical.

10. Participation, Parties & Communities

Tuneable is designed around the idea that listeners can be **participants**, not merely consumers.

A participant can: - discover; - support; - recommend; - curate; - host; - DJ; - create; - collaborate; - build communities.

The Tuneable party system provides a practical expression of this philosophy.

A party can become a temporary musical democracy: people collectively influence what gets played, while hosts retain appropriate moderation and veto powers.

The same principles can eventually extend to clubs, festivals, bars, community spaces, radio, online events and local music scenes.

Tuneable should work at multiple scales:

Global → national → regional → city → community → party.

11. TuneBytes

TuneBytes are intended to recognise contribution to the Tuneable ecosystem.

The current system records TuneBytes transactions alongside information such as the underlying bid, discovery rank and calculation used to determine the reward.

The idea is that people who help discover and amplify music should themselves be recognised for that contribution.

TuneBytes may eventually become part of a broader system of community reputation, participation or governance. But Tuneable does not require speculative cryptocurrency economics to work. A token should never become the reason people participate in Tuneable.

Music comes first.

Any future tokenisation should serve the community rather than turn the community into an audience for a financial instrument.

12. Rights, Privacy & Integrity

Tuneable should respect both creators and participants.

Creators should retain ownership of their intellectual property unless they explicitly transfer those rights elsewhere.

The platform should provide appropriate mechanisms for creator verification, rights claims, ownership information, takedowns, opt-outs, disputes and revenue allocation.

At the same time, transparency should never become surveillance.

Tuneable should minimise unnecessary personal-data collection and distinguish between public cultural information and private personal information.

The platform should also maintain strong controls around financial integrity, fraud, account security, manipulation, creator claims and platform administration.

As the platform becomes more open and decentralised, these systems should become increasingly independently verifiable.

13. Commercial Partnerships

Tuneable is not anti-business.

Artists, labels, venues, festivals, developers, technology companies and ethical brands can all be valuable participants in the ecosystem.

Commercial partnerships may help Tuneable become sustainable and extend its reach.

But partnership should not automatically mean control.

Material commercial relationships should be disclosed where appropriate, and commercial influence should not be allowed to masquerade as community activity.

The principle is:

Commercial sustainability and community independence should reinforce one another, not compete with one another.

14. Governance

Tuneable currently requires founder stewardship to build its technology, establish its legal and financial infrastructure and protect its underlying mission.

But the people who create and sustain a community should eventually have meaningful influence over its future.

Tuneable therefore intends to develop governance mechanisms involving the wider ecosystem, including potentially: - listeners; - artists; - producers; - DJs; - labels; - collectives; - venues; - promoters; - developers; - educators; - community organisations.

The exact governance structure should be developed through experimentation rather than imposed prematurely.

15. Progressive Decentralisation

Tuneable's ambition is ultimately toward decentralised, community-led governance.

But decentralisation should be a process rather than a marketing claim.

We envisage several stages:

- 1. Founder Stewardship** — Build and protect the foundations.
- 2. Community Participation** — Create meaningful mechanisms for proposals, consultation and representation.
- 3. Community Treasury** — Place an increasing proportion of appropriate surplus under community governance.
- 4. Distributed Governance** — Move significant decisions toward community-controlled mechanisms.
- 5. DAO or Equivalent** — Where legally, technically and practically appropriate, establish a decentralised governance structure.

The objective is not:

Put everything on a blockchain.

The objective is:

Give the people who create and sustain Tuneable meaningful ownership of its future.

16. Community Ownership & Treasury

A successful community platform needs financial sustainability.

Tuneable should be able to employ people fairly, maintain infrastructure, invest in security, develop new technology, maintain reserves and withstand difficult periods.

But surplus should serve more than accumulation.

As Tuneable grows, we intend to explore community-controlled funds supporting areas such as emerging artists, music education, independent venues, community studios, cultural events, open-source infrastructure and creative residencies.

The long-term question is not:

Can Tuneable make money?

It is:

What should Tuneable do with the money it makes?

17. The Anti-Billionaire Principle

Tuneable does not oppose wealth.

Artists should be able to become wealthy from their work. Developers should be well paid. Employees should prosper. Entrepreneurs should be rewarded for creating useful infrastructure.

But the platform should not be designed as a machine for extracting extraordinary private wealth from the community it serves.

We therefore propose that executive remuneration be constitutionally constrained.

An initial framework for consideration is that no Tuneable Director should receive annual total compensation exceeding an **absolute ceiling of £1,000,000 per year**.

This proposed framework should be subject to legal review and community governance before becoming binding.

The underlying principle matters more than the number:

Tuneable should reward contribution without turning control of community infrastructure into a path to extreme personal enrichment.

We are not trying to build another machine for manufacturing billionaires.

18. Measuring Success

Revenue is necessary for sustainability, but it should not be Tuneable's only measure of success.

We should also measure:

Creator value - money reaching creators; - number of creators receiving support; - creator retention; - time to payout.

Discovery - new artists discovered; - emerging artists reaching charts; - geographical diversity; - genre diversity.

Community - active participants; - parties created; - community events; - repeat participation.

Economic efficiency - platform commission; - payment-processing costs; - operating costs; - percentage of creator-directed money reaching creators.

Openness - open-source contributions; - API usage; - community-built projects; - governance participation.

Social impact - community initiatives funded; - artists supported; - education supported; - independent music organisations supported.

The ultimate metric is not:

How much money does Tuneable capture?

It is:

How much musical value does Tuneable help circulate?

19. The Roadmap

Build

Create reliable financial, social and musical infrastructure. Establish the artist ecosystem. Develop tipping, discovery, parties and charts.

Prove

Demonstrate that community-supported discovery can surface music and deliver meaningful value to creators. Build relationships with artists, DJs, labels, collectives and venues.

Open

Progressively open-source significant infrastructure. Publish ranking methodology. Develop public APIs. Publish meaningful economic reporting.

Govern

Establish formal community participation. Develop stakeholder representation. Create community treasury mechanisms. Introduce community proposals and voting.

Decentralise

Move appropriate governance functions toward community control. Develop the Tuneable governance protocol. Explore the future role of TuneBytes. Develop community ownership mechanisms.

The Music Commons

The eventual objective is for Tuneable to become more than a company delivering a music product. It should become a piece of community-owned musical infrastructure.

20. Constitutional Commitments

Some principles should eventually become harder to change than ordinary product decisions.

Community Interest — Tuneable exists for community benefit.

Creator First — Creator-directed value should remain the primary destination of creator-directed payments.

Low Commission — The platform should operate within a defined commission ceiling.

Transparency — The economics and material governance of Tuneable should be publicly understandable.

Open Technology — The platform should progressively open technology and data wherever reasonably possible.

Democratic Discovery — Commercial relationships should not secretly control community rankings.

Responsible Governance — Power should progressively be distributed to the community.

Constrained Extraction — Executive enrichment and excessive concentration of ownership should be actively constrained.

These principles should eventually receive appropriate constitutional and governance protection.

21. The Tuneable Covenant

Tuneable is a platform, but it is also an experiment in building a different kind of digital institution.

We will not build Tuneable to extract maximum value from music.

We will build it to return value to music.

We will not treat listeners as consumers and artists as suppliers. We will treat them as participants.

We will make it possible for people to demonstrate what music means to them.

We will seek to put more value into the hands of creators and less into the machinery of the platform.

We will keep our economics visible. We will publish where the money goes.

We will not secretly sell democratic influence. We will not allow commercial relationships to masquerade as community support.

We will progressively open our technology. We will progressively open our governance.

We will protect individual privacy while making the system itself increasingly transparent.

We will not build a speculative financial instrument and call it a community.

We will use technology in service of music, not music in service of technology.

We will reward contribution. We will constrain extraction. We will limit executive enrichment.

We will seek to ensure that nobody becomes extraordinarily wealthy merely by controlling infrastructure through which a community supports music.

We will build for the global music community, not merely the wealthiest markets.

And we will remember that Tuneable's ultimate measure of success is not how much wealth the platform accumulates.

It is how much **music, creativity, connection, opportunity and community** it enables.

22. Conclusion — The Music Commons

Tuneable begins as a platform.

It may become infrastructure.

It may become a cooperative.

It may become a DAO.

It may eventually become something we do not yet have a name for.

We do not need to know exactly what the final form will be.

We do need to decide what principles guide the journey.

Music is one of humanity's great shared languages.

The internet gave us unprecedented access to it.

The next challenge is to create better systems for discovering it, supporting it and participating in it.

Tuneable is an experiment in doing exactly that.

The objective is not to own the music.

The objective is to help the people who make, discover and love it own more of its future.

THE MUSIC COMMONS

The objective is not to own the music.

The objective is to help the people who make, discover and love it own more of its future.

Discover. Support. Participate.